

concerned with the quotes and the fibs. Then, however, if the occasion and mood seem to call for it, comes the time when, still under the impression that they are doing an important day's work, they present their Thoughts. These may be on a particular stock, on The Market in general, or on the destiny of the nation.

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*What we are constantly exchanging over an incredible network of wires are quotations, orders, bluffs, fibs, lies, and nonsense.*

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Let us consider two highly typical Thoughts.

Thought Number One is: "Looks there might be a little rally after lunch." This is proffered by young Mr. Joseph Wisenheimer, who had two years at Central High. At the time of his inspiration he is chewing gum and watching the ticker tape. He accompanies his pronouncement with a look so knowing it scarcely misses being a leer.

Thought Number Two is presented by Mr. S. Hugo Bigshot, and goes out on all wires. Let me skip down to its conclusion:

It therefore becomes clear that over the period of the next fifteen years the investment demand for sound convertible issues bearing a low coupon but carrying an attractive conversion feature will find such a deserved popularity with the long-sighted investor as to cause the more classic forms of indenture to look to their laurels.

Now the question is: Which of those two statements is the sillier? Either of them, you understand, might be correct. And both of them (or statements much like them) have sold billions of dollars' worth of securities.

Perhaps you veer toward Thought Two, because onomatopoeically it has a sillier sound.